



Notes

Jul 22, 2026

Understanding User Needs w Product (Content Partnerships: Ryan)

Invited Jade Nakabayashi Ryan Middledorf

Attachments 📎 Understanding User Needs w Product (Content Partnerships: Ryan)

Meeting records 📋 Transcript 🎙 Recording

Summary

Meeting discussions aligned on streamlining manual onboarding workflows and implementing automated system reporting for platform efficiency.

Onboarding Process Challenges

Manual data collection and survey limitations currently hinder onboarding efficiency. A centralized invitation portal was identified to consolidate talent profile management and survey completion.

System Automation Opportunities

Weekly manual spot checks and status tracking require automation via API integration for ad verification and report generation. A signal system is needed to denote show readiness.

Vetting and Access Management

Delayed vetting responses currently threaten deal closure timelines. Implementing automated alerts for deadlines and streamlining multi-user access configuration will improve overall workflow productivity.

Decisions

Needs Further Discussion

- **Automated Vetting Notification System** The automated notification system for vetting approvals is proposed, but requires further discussion to balance operational efficiency with the maintenance of human client relationship management.

We've **updated the Decisions section** using your feedback.

Let us know what you think: [Helpful](#) or [Not Helpful](#)

Next steps

- ☐ [Ryan Middledorf] Send onboarding updates: Deliver the Google sheet detailing desired onboarding process changes to Jade Nakabayashi via Slack.

Details

- **Project Scope and Objectives:** Jade Nakabayashi met with Ryan Middledorf to onboard onto the product team and gain an understanding of the current "daylight" ecosystem ([00:00:00](#)). The discussion focused on mapping out the current tools, identifying friction points, and gathering insights into what processes should be retained or improved in the new iteration of the product ([00:00:50](#)).
- **Current Onboarding Process:** Ryan Middledorf oversees the onboarding of new shows, which involves gathering approximately 20 to 30 data points. While a checklist exists, the process is largely manual, requiring Ryan Middledorf to

conduct onboarding calls with talent and producers to walk them through best practices and ad sales procedures before moving to the next steps ([00:01:42](#)).

- **Talent and Show Survey Optimization:** The onboarding phase utilizes talent and show-specific surveys ([00:03:51](#)). Ryan Middledorf noted that these forms contain outdated data fields and are missing categories like supplements and artificial intelligence ([00:04:47](#)). They suggested implementing a system that sends automated notifications every six months to prompt users to update their information, such as changes in pet ownership or contact details ([00:05:44](#)).
- **Unified Onboarding Workflow:** Ryan Middledorf envisions a more streamlined process for new shows, specifically requesting an "invitation to vault" link ([00:07:00](#)). This would allow producers or talent to use a single sign-on to add talent profiles and complete all necessary onboarding surveys in one location, eliminating the need to search for information across disparate sources ([00:08:04](#)).
- **Onboarding Readiness and Visibility:** The current onboarding workflow requires Jay to manually coordinate information before it can be sent to sales. Ryan Middledorf identified the need for a "green light, red light" system within the platform that would automatically signal when a show has submitted all required information and is officially ready for launch ([00:09:08](#)).
- **Advertiser Spot Check Procedures:** Ryan Middledorf performs weekly manual spot checks to ensure ads aired and lasted at least 60 seconds, as required by advertiser contracts. Because falling below this threshold necessitates "make goods," Ryan Middledorf must manually copy data from Podscribe into Google Sheets ([00:10:14](#)) ([00:12:08](#)). They proposed using the Podscribe API to pull this data automatically for easier verification ([00:11:10](#)).
- **Automated Reporting and Weekly Checklists:** To track show status, vetting, and ad markers, Ryan Middledorf manually maintains weekly checklists ([00:13:05](#)). They requested an automated feature in the new platform that would allow them to "generate report" for a specific show, pulling all available stats, billing information, and approval statuses into a single, comprehensive view for periodic check-ins ([00:14:04](#)).
- **System Performance and Dashboarding:** The current platform suffers from performance issues and slow loading times, forcing reliance on external Google Sheets to prevent data loss or system crashes ([00:16:03](#)). Ryan Middledorf

suggested creating individual, cleaner dashboards for each partner to display specific shows, fill rates, and pending tasks at a glance ([00:17:00](#)).

- **Vetting Process and Timeline:** A critical part of the role involves managing vetting, where sales send brands to shows for approval ([00:17:54](#)). Ryan Middledorf monitors these responses, as they must be completed within 48 hours to secure deals before brand budgets are allocated elsewhere. Currently, this tracking is done manually ([00:19:01](#)).
- **Vetting Notification Automation:** To avoid missing opportunities due to delayed vetting, Ryan Middledorf suggested that the platform include an automated alert system. This would notify them or the shows when a vetting response is approaching or has exceeded the 48-hour deadline, potentially including an option to autogenerate customizable emails to the show to resolve the delay without losing the personal nature of the relationship ([00:20:12](#)).
- **User Access and Configuration:** Creating user accounts for large organizations, such as the Daily Beast, is a time-consuming, manual process. Ryan Middledorf must manually add each person, assign specific access levels (Full Marley, Read Only, Marley Light, or Marley Light with no financials), and send invitation emails for every individual ([00:23:11](#)).
- **Survey and Data Entry Limitations:** A significant blocker in the current onboarding process is that surveys are tied to a single email address. This prevents multiple users from collaborating on the same survey, forcing them to share logins or complete the process as a single individual. Ryan Middledorf highlighted this as a point of frustration that slows down the onboarding timeline ([00:25:30](#)).
- **Relationship Maintenance and Progress Tracking:** Following the initial onboarding, Ryan Middledorf maintains ongoing relationships with shows through regular check-ins and operational support ([00:26:32](#)). To improve oversight, they suggested a visual progress tracker, such as a completion percentage, that would clearly identify which onboarding steps remain for each show ([00:27:29](#)).

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Transcript

Jul 22, 2026

Understanding User Needs w Product (Content Partnerships: Ryan) - Transcript

00:00:00

Jade Nakabayashi: Hello. Hello.

Ryan Middledorf: Hi, Jade. How are you?

Jade Nakabayashi: I'm well. How are you?

Ryan Middledorf: I'm doing well. Nice to meet you.

Jade Nakabayashi: Thank you for being flexible.

Ryan Middledorf: Yeah, of course. Of course.

Jade Nakabayashi: Lovely to meet you as well. How are you doing? How's your day going?

Ryan Middledorf: Doing well. Just a regular old Wednesday.

Jade Nakabayashi: Cool.

Ryan Middledorf: How about you?

Jade Nakabayashi: Yeah, it's finally nice out again, so it's a good day.

Ryan Middledorf: Yeah. Are you based in LA?

Jade Nakabayashi: I'm in Brooklyn.

Ryan Middledorf: Brooklyn. Okay. Okay.

Jade Nakabayashi: Yeah.

Ryan Middledorf: Nice.

Jade Nakabayashi: Um, do you mind if I record this call just for my future?

Ryan Middledorf: Not at all. Yeah, go

Jade Nakabayashi: Wonderful. Thank you so much.

Ryan Middledorf: ahead.

Jade Nakabayashi: Okay. So, hi. I'm Jade. I don't know how much you know about me that I exist. I think that people told you, but I've been brought on to help salmon product out with the new iteration of product.

00:00:50

Jade Nakabayashi: Um, and I'm just talking to everyone trying to understand like what daylight is and how the full organism functions, right? So, this is like one part onboarding, one part like really just giving you the space to say like this is what works really well for me. This is what doesn't work.

Ryan Middledorf: Sure.

Jade Nakabayashi: This is kind of what I'd like to see. Um, but I'm really just trying to like understand the landscape. I've only talked to Jay, so one other person from content partnerships and was told like you're the one to talk to about like onboarding in one sheet specifically, but I don't know how true that is. You'll tell me. Um, but also like what's been really helpful is as you're talking about what you do, if you can screen share and kind of like walk me through the tools you're using, like what you're using, how you're using them. Um,

Ryan Middledorf: Yeah.

Jade Nakabayashi: and like the friction that you're experiencing or like what does work really well and you would want to see carried over into the new

00:01:42

Ryan Middledorf: Yeah,

Jade Nakabayashi: system.

Ryan Middledorf: of course. Happy to. I will uh share my screen right now.

Jade Nakabayashi: Sweet.

Ryan Middledorf: One sec. Can you see that? Okay.

Jade Nakabayashi: Yep.

Ryan Middledorf: Okay. Perfect. So um yeah in terms of my role uh I am in charge of all of the onboardings. So when we bring a new show into the network when uh BSD

Jade Nakabayashi: Okay.

Ryan Middledorf: signs a new show they get brought over to us and there's probably about uh 20 to 30 different uh fields different pieces of information that we need to grab from shows before they can get officially onboarded. And right now it's a pretty manual process. There's a lot that is um you know built out through various surveys and things like that. But I'll kind of give you an overview of the onboarding tab here. This is under business. Um and just this uh little rocket ship here is onboarding. So, uh, we had Scott build out this onboarding checklist a couple months ago, just because, like I mentioned, a lot of this stuff was manual for a long time.

00:02:53

Jade Nakabayashi: I'm sorry.

Ryan Middledorf: So, uh, you know, being able to go in and just kind of check off if things were completed was really helpful. It's just kind of a band-aid to the um the process that we have right now. Uh but essentially,

Jade Nakabayashi: Yeah.

Ryan Middledorf: you know, we bring on a new show and how the process works is we'll just use this guard the yard as an example. This is a new show that we're working with. We uh would add talent here. This is a Yardly Smith show. So, let me see.

Jade Nakabayashi: Heat.

Ryan Middledorf: Here we go. Sometimes we'll have to build out new talent profiles for the talent, other times not if they're already in the system. And how it works essentially is we will have an onboarding call with either the talent or the producers or both. Walk them through our best practices. Uh walk them through how ad sales work and then after that we will move into kind of the next steps onboarding phase.

00:03:51

Ryan Middledorf: that involves uh couple things, primary of which are two surveys. There's going to be talent surveys, surveys specific to the talent of each show,

Jade Nakabayashi: Oops.

Ryan Middledorf: and then a show survey. I don't have access to edit the talent surveys or show surveys, but essentially just kind of walking you through it. The talent surveys pull in a bunch of this information. And so the survey is going to ask, you know, their birthday, a talent bio, um, websites, things like that. They can choose to fill out things, choose not to fill out things. So there is a little bit of just kind of combing through and searching, making sure we have everything we need,

Jade Nakabayashi: is

Ryan Middledorf: including Sorry.

Jade Nakabayashi: every

Ryan Middledorf: Um, you know, I I was just going to say including, you know, things like, do you have pets? Are you a homeowner? Things like that. is all included in the uh the talent survey.

Jade Nakabayashi: is there anything in here that you think like is not valuable anymore that we just have because we had it historically And like we're not

00:04:47

Ryan Middledorf: Um yes.

Jade Nakabayashi: using it.

Ryan Middledorf: Um actually a couple months ago I made this sheet.

Jade Nakabayashi: Oh,

Ryan Middledorf: This is kind of uh a an ideal updated sheet of um

Jade Nakabayashi: cool. Oh, amazing.

Ryan Middledorf: onboarding. So I'll send this to you as well. I sent it to Sam.

Jade Nakabayashi: That would be great.

Ryan Middledorf: Um, but this is kind of a breakdown of all the changes that I would like to to make and I'll send this

Jade Nakabayashi: Amazing.

Ryan Middledorf: to you if you have any questions, you know, obviously feel free to reach out. But,

Jade Nakabayashi: Thank you.

Ryan Middledorf: um, yeah, there's a lot on this page, this tab in general that is outdated that we can remove and a lot of things that we need to add. Um, so this is just kind of a breakdown of the the talent survey. One of the key things here is add category approvals. We obviously need to add a couple things to this. Um, these are categories that hosts do not want to have in their show from an advertising standpoint.

00:05:44

Ryan Middledorf: We have THC,

Jade Nakabayashi: Mhm.

Ryan Middledorf: alcohol, sports betting. We need to add things like supplements, AI, couple other fields that are usually um, you know, kind of sticky subjects for for talent.

Some are totally Cool. For example, with AI ads, some don't want them at all. So, we just want to, you know, add some additional category approvals here. But of other things

Jade Nakabayashi: This is being like autogenerated from like a Google form survey,

Ryan Middledorf: like Yeah.

Jade Nakabayashi: right,

Ryan Middledorf: Yeah.

Jade Nakabayashi: of some sort.

Ryan Middledorf: This is from uh I don't know if it's survey monkey or uh I'm not sure exactly the survey that we have but yeah it's one of those autogenerated I'm

Jade Nakabayashi: How often are you updating it after they submit that survey?

Ryan Middledorf: sorry very rarely and something that

Jade Nakabayashi: How often are you updating this after they submit that survey?

Ryan Middledorf: we want to build into the platform is you know once every six months maybe they get a

Jade Nakabayashi: Okay.

Ryan Middledorf: notification that says hey it's time to take a look at your um you know a couple different fields like you know um uh for example like do you have a new pet in the family things like that that we could you know every 6 months ask them to to update their information on which would be helpful.

00:07:00

Jade Nakabayashi: And then when you selected this yardly talent and you said where is it being pumped

Ryan Middledorf: So

Jade Nakabayashi: in from?

Ryan Middledorf: uh that's a great question. Um I believe it's currently pulling from See? Oh, yeah. Probably from the talent

Jade Nakabayashi: Okay.

Ryan Middledorf: field

Jade Nakabayashi: So if this is onboarding, how come they already exist in the system?

Ryan Middledorf: because we already have uh a show with Yardley Smith as one of the talent.

Jade Nakabayashi: Okay. Okay.

Ryan Middledorf: Yeah. So, at some point we created a talent profile for her and then

Jade Nakabayashi: Okay.

Ryan Middledorf: um now that we have that in the system, we can just add her to this show. But for example, this is a brand new show. We've never had these hosts before. It's called I've had it. And what we need to do here is we need to go in and actually create a new uh talent profile for these hosts. So,

Jade Nakabayashi: Okay.

Ryan Middledorf: kind of, you know, an ideal workflow, at least for me, would be we have that onboarding call with the talent, the producers, or both.

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Ryan Middledorf: And then when I send the follow-up email, I can just send them one link. It's just like here's your invitation to vault. Sign in, add the talent to the show. Um, and they can do everything,

Jade Nakabayashi: Mhm.

Ryan Middledorf: you know, right from one link as opposed to having to go through and kind of comb and find all this information. Um, so that's kind of the talent portion. Then there's also, like I mentioned, the show survey. We send that by popping in an email here, sending off the welcome survey. That's going to pull in things like episode frequency, how often are they dropping episodes, the days the episodes released, downloads, if they have a promo code they want to use, etc. So, more information specific to the actual podcast itself.

Jade Nakabayashi: Mhm.

Ryan Middledorf: Um, and like I said, a lot of these fields in here don't necessarily need to be here anymore. Like for example, we have a bunch of stuff uh down here in terms of marketing that doesn't need to be there.

00:09:08

Ryan Middledorf: I I've outlined kind of all of it in this onboarding updates Google sheet to kind of make it easier. But yeah, I mean the onboarding process right now it's pretty timely because a lot of this information or I would say 99% of this information needs to be pulled in before we can officially send anything off to sales. And Jay is the one to send everything to them. He packages it all together, sends it in a new show email, and ideally it's something where we send the talent, the producers a link, they get everything filled out, they can get their Marley login from there, uh, and they're not able to kind of fully submit everything until we have all this information in. And then, you know, Jay would essentially see like a green light, red light if he's able to officially launch that show or not.

Jade Nakabayashi: Okay, that makes sense. Can you talk me through? So, is this the only like part of the tool that you're really using today? Just this onboarding

Ryan Middledorf: No, I mean there there's more of it.

00:10:14

Jade Nakabayashi: tab.

Ryan Middledorf: So, one of the other things that I do is I go in each week, and I have this right now on a Google sheet just because it's much easier for me to work with than it currently is on Marley, but I go in each week to all of the shows and check to make sure their spots aired. So, I'm checking one to make sure the spot aired and then also how long the spot was. Not sure if anyone's walked you through Podscribe yet.

Jade Nakabayashi: Yeah, I've seen a little bit of it.

Ryan Middledorf: Okay. Yeah. So,

Jade Nakabayashi: Yeah,

Ryan Middledorf: I go through manually and pull in this data from Podscribe, which you know, as you can imagine, for a week,

Jade Nakabayashi: excruciating.

Ryan Middledorf: a week that has 150 ads, it's a lot of manual just checking spot length and stuff like that. Um,

Jade Nakabayashi: Yeah.

Ryan Middledorf: but I pull this breakdown from this tab in Marley. It's going to be uh the spot check, I believe. Yeah, spot check.

00:11:10

Ryan Middledorf: So, I'll enter the Monday of the week. Let's say for this week that pulls in all of the ads, and I essentially copy and paste these three columns into a new spreadsheet. And then I go in manually and I pull in all those ads. So this is one aspect of the platform that I use. Uh just doing the advertiser spot checks. Talking to Scott a couple months ago when we really started kind of talking about building this out more in the new platform. One of the things that we had discussed is potentially using the Podscribe API to pull in uh everything automatically and then maybe I could just go in

Jade Nakabayashi: Yeah.

Ryan Middledorf: and cross reference and double check as opposed to having to go in and manually pop in the spot length, for example. Um,

Jade Nakabayashi: Why do you have to do this?

Ryan Middledorf: I'm not sure.

Jade Nakabayashi: I I'm sorry for my ignorance,

Ryan Middledorf: No,

Jade Nakabayashi: but what's the point

Ryan Middledorf: no, no, that's okay. Uh, so yeah.

00:12:08

Ryan Middledorf: Yeah, great question. So, for sales,

Jade Nakabayashi: of

Ryan Middledorf: someone needs to go in and make sure that these spots actually ran. So, kind of twofold. We need to make sure that spots run in their given weeks just to make sure that we are uh you know making good on the promise to advertisers that like for example BetterHelp for you should know aired during the week of 713 and then two we need to make sure that the spot length is at least 60 seconds.

Jade Nakabayashi: Okay.

Ryan Middledorf: If it is under 60 seconds then we are kind of out of contract with the advertiser. We commit at least 60 seconds to them. So if they are under 60 seconds, you know, say like 55 seconds, there's like a little bit of leeway there. But if they're like 45 seconds for example, then we need to provide a make good and ad ops sales. They need to know all that. So every Monday I send them this

Jade Nakabayashi: Okay. Okay.

Ryan Middledorf: report.

00:13:05

Jade Nakabayashi: So, this is just like dotting your eyes and crossing your tees basically. And this then it goes out to sales you said, right?

Ryan Middledorf: Exactly.

Jade Nakabayashi: Yeah.

Ryan Middledorf: Yep.

Jade Nakabayashi: Okay.

Ryan Middledorf: Yep. That's exactly right.

Jade Nakabayashi: Cool. That makes sense. That sounds extremely tedious.

Ryan Middledorf: It is pretty tedious.

Jade Nakabayashi: can fix your life a little

Ryan Middledorf: Yeah. No, thank you. I appreciate it. Um, and then the other thing that we have here in Marley that

Jade Nakabayashi: bit.

Ryan Middledorf: we don't really use anymore, but I think we'd like to bring it back in some capacity is this weekly checklist. So, I'm sure Jay mentioned uh this or a version of this a little bit, but for each of us in content partnerships, we all have our own shows that we oversee and represent and you know, they're they're the ones that we are responsible for. And each week, each day, it's helpful for us to go in and just cross reference, make sure that things are going well with the show.

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Ryan Middledorf: Like, are they tackling their vetting? um are they uh doing their ad markers for their episodes, things like that. Um there's currently no easy way for us to

Jade Nakabayashi: Mhm.

Ryan Middledorf: pull in a lot of this information aside from going in and doing it manually. So something that Jay has been asking for in the new platform, and apologies if you brought this up already, but a Okay, great. a way to generate a essentially a report for each show where we can go

Jade Nakabayashi: Never.

Ryan Middledorf: into uh the Y files for example, go into their show and just tap generate report and it just pulls in all of their stats that are available to us in Marley. So we can see everything at a glance. It's helpful for us when we have bi-weekly or monthly check-ins with the show. So, we can go over billing, we can go over uh uh you know, their vetting, their approvals, their wise, things like that. Right now, we kind of have to hunt in the system a little bit to find all that information.

00:15:13

Ryan Middledorf: There's no real easy way to kind of pull everything in at once. Um now, what all those fields are, what we necessarily need.

Jade Nakabayashi: Yeah, that was going to be my next

Ryan Middledorf: Yeah, you know,

Jade Nakabayashi: question.

Ryan Middledorf: that's probably a larger conversation, something that that Jay probably really needs to be a part of. Um,

Jade Nakabayashi: Okay.

Ryan Middledorf: but ideally, it'd be something where we could, you know, check boxes like, do I want to get a digest of their ad plan? Do I want to get a digest of their vetting approval? Um, you know,

Jade Nakabayashi: right?

Ryan Middledorf: really kind of tailor it to what we need.

Jade Nakabayashi: Like a custom generated report that basically has everything that you're doing manually in the checklist, but that it'll pump it out for you,

Ryan Middledorf: Ex. Exactly.

Jade Nakabayashi: right?

Ryan Middledorf: Exactly. Yeah. Just to save that extra, you know, 20, 30 minutes that it takes to pull in those

Jade Nakabayashi: Yeah, I know reporting is like coming and I know that Kate is like spearheading an effort to

00:16:03

Ryan Middledorf: stats.

Jade Nakabayashi: get what everybody needs to see from everyone. So, I think that that's probably part of that effort, but it's really helpful to hear for me too to have this

Ryan Middledorf: Great. Yeah. Yeah. Of course.

Jade Nakabayashi: context.

Ryan Middledorf: So, I would say those are, you know, certainly onboarding. That's what I use Marley for the absolute most. Um, and I'll send you this uh onboarding updates sheet as well,

Jade Nakabayashi: Yeah, that would be

Ryan Middledorf: so you have it. Yeah, you bet. Um, and then the spot checks as well.

Jade Nakabayashi: awesome.

Ryan Middledorf: I'm not entering anything into Marley in terms of the spot checks just because uh this table is very slow and clunky and it kind of you know sort of boots me out a lot. Um so I just have done everything in these Google Sheets.

Jade Nakabayashi: Yeah,

Ryan Middledorf: Um,

Jade Nakabayashi: that's crazy that you've just had to recreate what's in there here because the performance is so

Ryan Middledorf: yeah, it's,

00:17:00

Jade Nakabayashi: poor.

Ryan Middledorf: you know, uh, it, like I said, it was just kind of a band-aid until we got to,

Jade Nakabayashi: Yeah.

Ryan Middledorf: uh,

Jade Nakabayashi: Yeah.

Ryan Middledorf: a better place. So,

Jade Nakabayashi: Yeah.

Ryan Middledorf: um, that's really kind of the long and short of it in terms of what I'm doing. Uh, in terms of the one sheets you referenced, that's really going to be Annie. She's the one that's kind of in charge of that and oversees that.

Jade Nakabayashi: Okay.

Ryan Middledorf: Um, I guess I can show you too. Uh, we have these pages, these go Ryan go soo go pages at the time when

Jade Nakabayashi: Mhm.

Ryan Middledorf: these were created. This kind of goes back to what I was talking about in terms of generating reports. But this would be a uh general overview of the shows that I'm responsible for.

Jade Nakabayashi: Okay.

Ryan Middledorf: So,

Jade Nakabayashi: So,

Ryan Middledorf: you know how many Exactly.

Jade Nakabayashi: this is just the band-aid for your recording effectively.

Ryan Middledorf: Exactly.

Jade Nakabayashi: Yeah.

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Ryan Middledorf: We don't use this all of the time, but It'd be great in some sort of dashboard to see, okay, here are the shows that I'm responsible for? Um, are there any issues like, you know, is uh is fill rate low on a certain show? Is uh vetting behind 48 hours, for example? Actually, that's something I can show you, too. Um but yeah, for this general page, I would envision this as kind of like, you know, our individual dashboards almost in an ideal um ideal platform. Um but vetting,

Jade Nakabayashi: Okay.

Ryan Middledorf: now that I'm thinking about it, vetting is something that I tackle as well. So in these reports that I'm sending sales, I'm sending them the spot check report and then I'm also sending them a vetting update. So, with vets, you know how the process works, and I'm sure Kate and Jay have probably walked you through this as

well, but sales will send vets to a show to see if they want to work with a certain brand, and then those shows ideally will turn around that vet within 48

00:19:01

Jade Nakabayashi: Mhm.

Ryan Middledorf: hours with a Y statement. So, why they want to work with X brand.

Jade Nakabayashi: Yeah.

Ryan Middledorf: And the 48 hour time frame is really important for us because if we get a vet back to the brand within 48 hours, we can lock in deals before those brand dollars are spoken for. Anything outside of 48 hours, a lot of those budgets are already covered. So, if a uh host comes back to us 72 hours and says, "Yes, I really want to work with Thrive Market," for example, nine times out of 10 that money is gone and we've lost out on that opportunity.

Jade Nakabayashi: Yeah.

Ryan Middledorf: So, it's important to see the vetting at a glance and know when shows are slipping past that 48 hour mark. This is another thing that I manually do and I go in uh you know every other day and just kind of see how shows are doing. So I'll kind of remove this. We can see it at a glance. But for example, you know, today's the 22nd, yesterday was the 21st.

00:20:12

Ryan Middledorf: So really looking at anything that is, you know, 7:20 like these are now kind of past 48 hours. So, I know that I need to reach out to these shows and say, "Hey,

Jade Nakabayashi: Mhm.

Ryan Middledorf: we really need to stay on top of vets. We really need to get these in a little bit sooner because we're going to start losing out on opportunities." So, being able to see that at a glance and then also possibly building in some sort of notification system uh where vets do slip past 48 hours. Maybe the system automatically sends the folks that need to do vets uh an

Jade Nakabayashi: No.

Ryan Middledorf: alert says, "Hey, you're approaching 48 hours, you're past 48 hours, you're at 72 hours." Like things like that. And so So we can really ensure that they get into a rhythm of responding to these before it becomes an issue.

Jade Nakabayashi: Is there anything of like the human touch point being lost if we automate that process? Do you think that that because it sounds like you're really you're managing the like

00:21:15

Ryan Middledorf: Mhm.

Jade Nakabayashi: client relationship throughout, right?

Ryan Middledorf: Yeah. Uh it's it's a good question. It's a good point. Um, at the very least it'd be something that would be great for me to receive updates on as opposed to having to go in here manually each day.

Jade Nakabayashi: Yeah. Yeah.

Ryan Middledorf: The Yeah,

Jade Nakabayashi: Of

Ryan Middledorf: maybe get an update on my end that says, "Hey,

Jade Nakabayashi: course.

Ryan Middledorf: uh, I think you're overthinking it is getting behind on their vets." And then maybe there's a button I can hit in the platform where it autogenerates an email that I can customize and then send out.

Jade Nakabayashi: Or maybe there's like an elevation where they like are really doing this all the time and it's like now you need to intervene because

Ryan Middledorf: Exactly. Yeah. Yeah. So, I I think the the actual methodology

Jade Nakabayashi: Yeah.

Ryan Middledorf: behind how they're notified, you know, we probably need to talk about a little bit more, but at least some sort of notification system.

00:22:10

Ryan Middledorf: So, at the very least, I know what's going

Jade Nakabayashi: Okay,

Ryan Middledorf: on.

Jade Nakabayashi: that makes sense. Um I'm just trying like trying to take a step back, right?

Ryan Middledorf: Mhm.

Jade Nakabayashi: So like how you play into the larger s. So So we sign a new show and then you're you have a call with them and you walk them through the onboarding, right? Like are you sending the survey to them or they just get the survey as part of their like little package

Ryan Middledorf: Yep. So, I'm sending the survey to them.

Jade Nakabayashi: or

Ryan Middledorf: I send them a couple things. I send them uh their talent survey, their show survey, and then I also will send them Marley loginins. Um, so that I'll show you kind of what that looks like.

Jade Nakabayashi: Okay.

Ryan Middledorf: I have to go into admin light, go to users, add a user. We need to here I'll just kind of walk you through it so you can see test. Uh, leave that blank, but we'll create that.

00:23:11

Ryan Middledorf: And this is this is one of the more tedious uh aspects of the onboarding process especially for a show with a large organization. For example, we signed recently um the Daily Beast which is a news organization.

Jade Nakabayashi: Mhm.

Ryan Middledorf: They have six different shows and probably 15 to 20 people that needed to have access to Marley.

Jade Nakabayashi: Mhm.

Ryan Middledorf: So, I need to uh I needed to go through and sign individual people up for the platform. So, I need to go in here. This is the test one that we just built. Need to make sure their email is filled out. I need to add them to a certain show. Provide the type of Marley access. There's Full Marley, which is access to everything uh including vetting. There's full Marley, which is read only, which is essentially everything minus vetting. Then there's Marley Light, which is Marley with no financials plus vetting. And then there's Marley Light with no financials, which is everything minus financials and minus vetting. So, uh those are kind of the options we have.

00:24:25

Ryan Middledorf: Then I need to go here and click Marley invitation sent. Make sure the correct podcast is added. Make sure I add if they're, you know, a talent, a producer, agent, whatever it is. And then that would spit out an automated email. I need to copy and paste that email into a Gmail and then send that off. I need to do that for each individual person which is a lot especially like I said if

Jade Nakabayashi: That also sounds painful.

Ryan Middledorf: it's like 15 people you know that that whole process could take you know an hour

Jade Nakabayashi: And then and then who who's getting the forms then? like one of those people and then it's their respon like one of these people who like has access to the system you then send this package to and they're able to access the system and fill out the forms and

Ryan Middledorf: Exactly. Exactly. And uh yeah, in terms of the surveys,

Jade Nakabayashi: then

Ryan Middledorf: you know, it could be the talent specifically, it could be a producer.

00:25:30

Ryan Middledorf: One tricky thing with the surveys is that they need to be connected to an email and they can only be connected to one email. So, for example, uh this guy Ben, who works at the company that produces the show, he was in charge of Yardley's onboarding surveys.

Jade Nakabayashi: Mhm.

Ryan Middledorf: If Ben only wanted to complete half of it or only could complete half of it, someone else would have to log in as Ben to complete the rest of the survey. It's not like we could send multiple surveys or multiple login for the same survey out. It needs to be connected to one email.

Jade Nakabayashi: Yeah,

Ryan Middledorf: So,

Jade Nakabayashi: that that just seems like a system maintenance blocker.

Ryan Middledorf: Yeah.

Jade Nakabayashi: Um,

Ryan Middledorf: Yeah. Just kind of slows down the process a little

Jade Nakabayashi: and then so like once they're onboarded, right? Like we've gotten them into the system,

Ryan Middledorf: bit.

Jade Nakabayashi: then you're just maintaining the then you're maintaining the relationship with that show, right? So you talked about the Oh, I'm trying to remember the language.

00:26:32

Jade Nakabayashi: The spot check.

Ryan Middledorf: Yeah. Yeah. Exactly. Yeah. Spot check.

Jade Nakabayashi: the spot check and you're going through that weekly checklist and just kind of keeping an eye on reporting and you're keeping an eye on like if they're vetting stuff, right, for the show that you're managing and then it's just like you do that forever while we're engaged with

Ryan Middledorf: Yeah,

Jade Nakabayashi: them.

Ryan Middledorf: exactly. Yeah.

Jade Nakabayashi: Okay.

Ryan Middledorf: Then it's uh then it's just kind of steady state from there. Um, you know, it's bi-weekly, monthly check-in. ends, you know, if there are any issues that pop up uh with ad ops or sales, working with the shows to make sure those are resolved. Um answer any questions they might have, that sort of thing. Just really maintaining those relationships and making sure we're doing uh the best job possible for not only the show, but also internally for us and our our sales.

Jade Nakabayashi: And then is it just is it just you doing on boarding at daylight or are there like other Orions?

00:27:29

Ryan Middledorf: It's just me. It's just me.

Jade Nakabayashi: Okay.

Ryan Middledorf: So, I I'm in charge of the entire onboarding phase. You know, uh Jay is on all of the uh those calls. Uh Annie's on all those calls. Soo is usually on those calls as well. But in terms of actually ushering the show through the onboarding process, that's all um that's all me.

Jade Nakabayashi: Okay, that's a

Ryan Middledorf: It's It's a lot.

Jade Nakabayashi: lot.

Ryan Middledorf: It's a lot. Um, you know, we've we've gotten by with this system, but as I'm sure you know, over time the system changes.

Jade Nakabayashi: available.

Ryan Middledorf: Uh, certain things break.

Jade Nakabayashi: Yeah.

Ryan Middledorf: Like, for example, this reps and agents field hasn't been working for for some time. Um, and yeah, there's just a bunch of I I would say just kind of bloat here that doesn't need to be here. Um,

Jade Nakabayashi: Yeah.

Ryan Middledorf: ideally this page would just be all the stuff I need and nothing else. And then I can see at a glance like,

00:28:24

Jade Nakabayashi: Yeah.

Ryan Middledorf: okay, um, you know, this is filled out, this is filled out, this is filled out, this is not filled out. So, something that we were also talking with Scott and Sam about was, you know, can we build in some sort of progress tracker where for like guard the yard? Maybe it says like, "Hey, we're 90% there, and I can see what's missing." Yeah.

Jade Nakabayashi: That's nice.

Ryan Middledorf: So,

Jade Nakabayashi: Yeah.

Ryan Middledorf: um, that's kind of the the long and short of it. I'm I'm sure I missed something. I'm sure I, you know,

Jade Nakabayashi: Oh, I'm sure I won't remember everything,

Ryan Middledorf: breeze past something, but of

Jade Nakabayashi: so you'll be hearing from me. Um, yeah. if anything comes up,

Ryan Middledorf: course.

Jade Nakabayashi: like if you think of anything you're like, "Oh, I wish I had talked to you about this." Like, please feel free to ping me at any point. Um, but yeah,

Ryan Middledorf: Okay.

Jade Nakabayashi: thank you so much for your time.

Ryan Middledorf: Of course.

Jade Nakabayashi: This has been super super helpful. So, I appreciate it.

Ryan Middledorf: And then for this onboarding updates sheet, you want me to slack that to you? Is that easiest?

Jade Nakabayashi: Um, yeah,

Ryan Middledorf: Okay,

Jade Nakabayashi: that's fine.

Ryan Middledorf: great. Um, I'll do that. But thank you so much for the time. I really appreciate it.

Jade Nakabayashi: Thank you so much. Have a good weekend.

Ryan Middledorf: Okay, you too. Thanks, Jade.

Jade Nakabayashi: Yeah. Okay. Bye.

Ryan Middledorf: Bye.

Transcription ended after 00:29:36

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